

the 1990s, the number of people in the UK who are obese has increased by 50% (Health Survey for England 1995, 1997, 1999, 2001, 2003, 2005, 2007, 2009, 2011, 2013, 2015, 2017, 2019, 2021).

Obesity is a complex condition with many causes, including genetics, environment, and lifestyle. It is a leading cause of death and disability in the UK, and is associated with a range of health problems, including heart disease, diabetes, and cancer. Obesity is also a major cause of social inequality, with people who are obese more likely to be poor and to have lower educational attainment.

There are a number of factors that can contribute to obesity, including a diet high in calories and fat, a sedentary lifestyle, and genetic factors. Obesity is also more likely to develop in people who are born to obese parents, or who are obese in childhood.

Obesity is a complex condition with many causes, and it is important to understand the factors that contribute to it in order to develop effective prevention and treatment strategies. This paper will review the current evidence on the causes of obesity, and will discuss the implications for public health policy.

The first section of the paper will discuss the prevalence of obesity in the UK, and will review the current evidence on the causes of obesity. The second section will discuss the implications of obesity for public health, and will review the current evidence on the effectiveness of interventions to prevent and treat obesity.

The third section will discuss the implications of obesity for social inequality, and will review the current evidence on the effectiveness of interventions to reduce social inequality. The fourth section will discuss the implications of obesity for the environment, and will review the current evidence on the effectiveness of interventions to reduce the environmental impact of obesity.

The paper will conclude by discussing the implications of the findings for public health policy.

2. Prevalence of obesity in the UK

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